

Macton Mgonzo

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Education

- 2021–Present **PhD. Computer Science**, Brown University, United States of America (USA).
- 2021–2024 **M.Sc. Computer Science**, Brown University, United States of America (USA).
- 2012–2014 **M.Sc. Infor & Comm Science and Engineering**, Nelson Mandela AIST, Tanzania.
- 2006–2009 **B.Sc. Computer Science (Honors)**, St. Augustine University, Tanzania.
First Class Honours (ranked 1st in year)

Work Experiences

- 2015–2021 **Assistant Lecturer**, Taught Advanced Business Mathematics & Programming in C/C++, College of Business Education, Dodoma, **Tanzania**
- 2018 **Data Scientist**, Led a team of 15 people to implement a scalable machine-learning solution to help smallholder farmers access financial services in rural Tanzania., Centre for Financial Regulation and Inclusion (Cenfri) - **South Africa**, Remote Part-time Job
- 2010–2014 **Tutorial Assistant**, Taught Business Mathematics & Programming in C, College of Business Education, Mwanza, **Tanzania**
- 2009–2010 **Tutorial Assistant**, Taught Introduction to Computer Graphics and Multimedia Systems (Class size: 28 Students), Ruaha Catholic University, Iringa, **Tanzania**

Publications

- 2025 **Esfandiarpour, R., Zerveas, G., Zhang, R., Mgonzo, M., Eickhoff, C., & Bach, S. H.**, Beyond Contrastive Learning: Synthetic Data Enables List-wise Training with Multiple Levels of Relevance, *EMNLP Findings*, 2025.

Conferences

- 2020 **EC 2020 Conference**, Online
Presented a poster titled **Reducing Information Asymmetry for Cashew Farmers in Tanzania**, showcasing a machine learning model that improves market access for Tanzanian cashew farmers.
- 2018 **Deep Learning Indaba 2018**, Stellenbosch, South Africa.
Presented a Poster titled **Automatic Logo Detection Using CNNs** at one of Africa's premier AI conferences. Ranked in the **top 274** posters out of **1,386** submissions.

Honors & Awards

- 2022 **Black in AI Conference Travel Awards**, New Orleans, USA.
- 2019, 2020 **ACM *FAccT Conference Travel Grant**, Atlanta, USA, Barcelona, Spain
- 2021 **Google CS Research Mentorship Program (CS-RMP)**
- 2018 **Google Conference Travel Award – Deep Learning Indaba**

Professional Service

- 2022 **Student Volunteer**: SIGIR 2022, ACM FAccT 2022
Managing attendee sessions, facilitating speaker presentations, and supporting the conference logistics team.

2020 **Co-Organiser:** IndabaX 2020, NM-AIST, Arusha:

Organized a mini Indaba event that attracted over 120 participants, including students and early-career researchers, to discuss advancements in machine learning.

Reviewing

2023 - 2025 Reviewer for Machine Learning for Healthcare (ML4H) Workshop

2024 Reviewer for Black in AI Workshop

2024, 2025 Reviewer for Deep Learning Indaba Conference

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python, C, C++, HTML, CSS, SQL, JavaScript.

Machine Learning Frameworks: Tensorflow, PyTorch, Keras, Scikit-learn, NumPy, HuggingFace.

Development Tools & Version Control: Git, Linux, LaTeX.

Certifications: Completed Coursera's Machine Learning and Deep Learning Specializations.

Data Analysis Tools: Proficient in Big Data Analytics frameworks and tools such as Hadoop and MapReduce, obtained during the Specialized Programme on Big Data Analytics at CDAC- Noida, **India** (2016–2017)